The Ghost Road Seal 鬼道

Sun Simiao, who wrote down the ashi point, closed his Qianjin yifang (682) with two volumes of spells. Before you chant over a talisman and command it, he says, hold the ghost road shut (捻斷鬼道): one line in the middle of your palm.

> **The idea.** A seal is a spot that brings back a state when you touch it, once you have paired the two, the same way, many times.



Red dot: Laogong 勞宮, PC 8.

1. **Find the spot.** The palm chapter names a line, not a point; I place the seal at Laogong 勞宮, PC 8, which Sun Simiao also calls ghost road (my reading). Make a loose fist; your middle fingertip lands on it. In TCM it calms the spirit; in qigong it sends and receives qi. Here it is a key to a state; nothing is treated.
2. **Hold it.** Open the hand and rest that hand's thumb tip on the spot: left hand when working for a man, right for a woman. A light touch with a small roll is a hold 捻; a hard push is a press 押, for when you need the state fast.
3. **Pair it with a state, about ten minutes.** Start with colour, the easiest layer to hold in mind.
   - Keep holding. Breathe in through the mouth, picturing green coming in sparkling, swallow it down into the liver, then breathe out through the mouth, the same green gone dull. That is one round; do seven.
   - Name what you feel: that is the state. Map each colour this way, on its own.

Direction	Colour	Organ	Phase	Season
東 east	green 青	肝 liver	wood	spring
南 south	red 赤	心 heart	fire	summer
西 west	white 白	肺 lungs	metal	autumn
北 north	black 黑	腎 kidneys	water	winter
中 centre	yellow 黃	脾 spleen	earth	late summer

   Then map direction, then season, each on its own before you stack them.
4. **Use it.** Before you chant over a talisman and command it (凡欲咒敕符), hold the spot, press if it is urgent, and call up the state you named in step 3.

@thezacharylui zacharylui.ca

Where each step comes from

- **The ghost road and hold or press** (凡欲咒敕符皆須捻斷鬼道; 急則而押之，緩則捻之): Qianjin yifang juan 29, Palm Formulas 掌訣法第五. The text says "one line in the middle of the palm" (掌中一理).
- **Directions, colours, mouth, seven breaths, swallow** (向東方吸青氣想入口中七吸; 入口滿七咽): Qianjin yifang juan 29, chapter 3.
- **My reading:** the ghost road as Laogong. The palm chapter: 掌中一理是鬼道, the line in the middle of the palm is the ghost road. Qianjin yifang juan 27: 勞宮，一名鬼路, Laogong, also called ghost road. The same juan's thirteen ghost points, from Bian Que (扁鵲曰), give point 9 as 從手橫紋三寸兩筋間 … 名鬼路，此名間使: Jianshi, PC 5, on the forearm, out of reach of the same hand's thumb. **Ashi** 阿是: Beiji qianjin yaofang juan 29, 灸例第六.
- **My practice:** the seal as a key to a state; sparkling in, dull out; colour first, direction and season later (the text faces east from the first breath); the colour sent to the organ, as the chapter 2 vow puts the binding there (想東方木禁在吾肝中).

Editions: Qianjin yifang, Chinese Wikisource; Beiji qianjin yaofang, 30-juan edition (ashi). Every claim carries its source, edition named.

SEVEN-DAY MAPPING LOG

A seal answers once it has been paired with the state many times. Run step 3 once a day for a week, then test it: hold Laogong cold and notice what comes back.

Day	Done	Layers mapped	What came back
1	☐		
2	☐		
3	☐		
4	☐		
5	☐		
6	☐		
7	☐		Test: hold it cold. Note what comes back.

Next step. When you are ready to take your seal further, that is what we do in coaching: mapping your seals, energy work, correspondences and stacking, and herbal magick and sorcery. 1-on-1, online, $175 + tax. **zacharylui.ca/coaching**



Zachary Lui is a 巫 (wū), a shaman and folk priest in Toronto. He carries Mao Shan Shangqing 茅山上清 Daoist transmission and works Tangmi 唐密, Chinese Esoteric Buddhism, in the folk register.

@thezacharylui
zacharylui.ca